

D10 | Sports

HIGH SCHOOLS

HOCKEY

TIM WARSINSKEY
Plain Dealer Reporter

St. Edward hockey coach Bob Whidden is coming to grips that this team isn't going to make life easy for him in his 20th season.

They are, however, going to win a lot of games.

The Eagles won another close one Friday night, 3-2, against rival St. Ignatius in front of more than 500 fans at Wintehurst Ice Rink in Lakewood.

Perhaps spoiled by a powerful team that averaged nearly five goals in league games last season, Whidden's team

#1 ST. EDWARD 3 struggled to score early this season, but has started to do the little things right around the net. The Eagles are averaging three goals per game.

"I don't think this team is going to score a lot of pretty goals," he said. "Maybe we don't have that knack yet. But we're starting to get the puck to the net and going to the net with our sticks down, and good things are starting to happen."

St. Edward took a 3-0 lead into the third period in a game that nearly was identical to its 3-2 victory over the Wild-

cats three weeks ago. In both games, St. Ignatius fell behind, 3-0, and scored its second goal late in the third period during a 6-on-4 advantage.

Friday night, St. Ignatius had a 6-on-4 for the final 95 seconds after a St. Edward penalty and goalie Ted Riolo was pulled. Junior center Jim McClain scored with 68 seconds left to make it 3-2. The Wildcats were unable to get a good look after that.

St. Edward (19-7; 7-1-1) remains atop the Red North. It entered the game with a three-point lead on Padua, which played Shaker Heights last Friday. Fifth-place St. Ignatius (10-15-3; 2-5) is on the

verge of missing the Baron Cup in a division that qualifies four teams.

St. Edward forward Dave Bruder, who had a goal and two assists in his first game back from a foot injury, set up the Eagles' first goal on a pass to defenseman Matt Musick, whose slap shot from the point slipped between a defenseman's skates. Bruder scored on what he called a "gift from God" with five minutes left in the first period. St. Ignatius, down a man, attempted to ice the puck but it bounced off a defenseman's helmet and landed at Bruder's feet. Bruder also set up Mark Wilson for the goal that gave the Eagles a 3-0 lead in the second.

St. Ignatius outshot the Eagles, 16-2, in the third period for a 28-20 final margin. St. Ignatius coach Scott Pick lamented his team's inability to challenge the Eagles until the third period of both games.

"We have played two good periods against St. Ed's and four pathetic periods," he said. "That has happened way too much this year. We have been too inconsistent for too long. We need to play with the sense of urgency that we played with in the third period."

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HIGH SCHOOL SCOREBOARD

BOYS BASKETBALL

Aurora City Series

Buckeye Hills

Central/Power 70, North 45

Garfield 64, Ellet 48

Kentwood 51, East 65

Chapin Valley Conference

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Lake Division

Overline

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